

Quarterly Labour Force Survey — Q2 2026

Release-day briefing — Statistics South Africa, P0211 (Quarterly Labour Force Survey)

LU1 unemployment rate

33,6%

LU3 (incl potential labour
force)

43,8%

Employment q/q

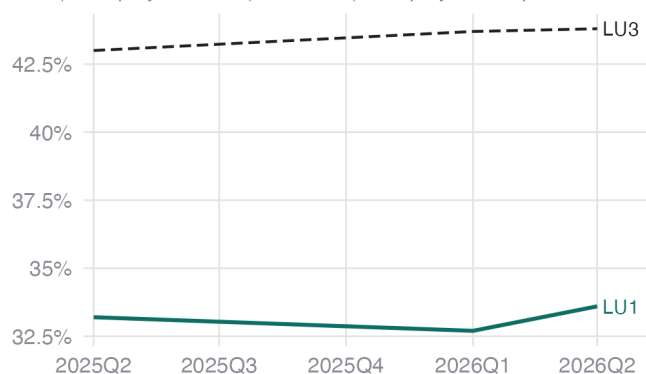
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Absorption rate

39,6%

Labour underutilisation

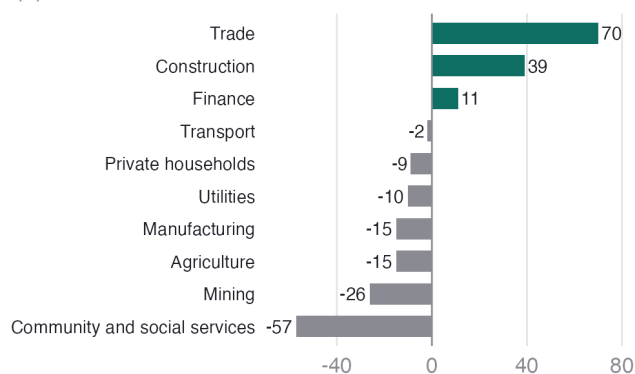
LU1 (unemployment rate) and LU3 (unemployment + potential labour



Source: Statistics South Africa, P0211. Retrieved 2026-08-26.

Employment change by industry, Q2 2026

q/q, thousands



Source: Statistics South Africa, P0211. Retrieved 2026-08-26.

Commentary

The official unemployment rate (LU1) was 33,6% in Q2 2026, a change of 0,9 pp on the quarter. LU3, which combines unemployment with the potential labour force, was 43,8% (0,1 pp q/q); reporting both is necessary because neither alone represents the South African labour market. Employment was 16 739 thousand (-16 thousand q/q); the absorption rate was 39,6% and participation 59,6%. Figures cover persons aged 15-64. Informal/formal sector estimates follow the 21st ICLS standard and are comparable only from Q3 2025 onward.

Industry	Level (thousand)	q/q change	y/y change
Trade	3 389	70	74
Construction	1 354	39	94
Finance	2 950	11	-33
Transport	1 108	-2	-7
Private households	1 092	-9	-14
Utilities	103	-10	-36
Agriculture	944	-15	39
Manufacturing	1 571	-15	-100
Mining	450	-26	16
Community and social services	3 771	-57	-101

Statistics South Africa, P0211 (Quarterly Labour Force Survey). Data retrieved 2026-08-26 19:58:08 UTC. QLFS estimates are not revised between releases; series breaks are documented in config/series_breaks.yaml.

Basic data: Statistics South Africa. Users may apply the information as they wish, provided they acknowledge Stats SA as the source of the basic data, and specify that the relevant application and analysis result from their own processing of the data.